

Google buys PittPatt

Google buys PittPatt, a facial recognition firm, despite privacy concerns and declaring it had no interest in facial recognition

Microsoft Tulalip

A new non-operational social search service called Tulalip was found at Socl.com. Microsoft later called it an internal design project <http://bit.ly/oaEubS>

Feature

ness. You can download your favorite music and playlists on your PC or mobile device. These tracks will be available in online/offline mode, on the Deezer Desktop or Deezer Mobile application, through the duration of the active subscription.

Bandwidth limitations

The biggest limitation with online audio streaming is the amount of bandwidth on offer, and the quality as well. If the Internet connection you're using is 512Kbps or more, then you'll be able to enjoy stutter-free online radio. Any lesser than that, and you might become good friends with the term 'buffering'! If using broadband at home (DSL etc.), the connection ideally should be more stable. Wherever you access these services - PC, smartphone, or devices like an HD media player - the connectivity and load times will be seamless.

You'll have a bigger connectivity problem if you're on a data card or

using the mobile network. 3G data cards with sufficient speeds and signals at that time will work fine. However, the older gen data cards with 144Kbps max speeds won't be the best tools for online streaming; neither would a GPRS/EDGE connection be. While EDGE will allow

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you to listen to music, it may be littered with paused and buffers, unless you select the lowest quality stream on offer.

Price factor

Online radio/streaming services offer, as we have illustrated in this article,

both - free and paid versions. If you aren't very finicky about having the absolute ultimate package available, we suggest trying out the free options. If they solve your requirement, fair and good, no need to pay! If they don't, and you want to use some of the extra features on offer, then pay for a subscription plan accordingly.

Most home users might be on unlimited data usage plans. However, be aware that most ISPs have a 'fair usage policy' set. Crossing that will mean the speed will get chopped quite a bit for the rest of the billing cycle. Those who have a data limited plan should keep a tab on their amount of usage, since streaming can eat up the MBs faster than you think. Avoid the trouble of a huge data usage bill at the end of the month.

We still haven't seen any truly unlimited data usage plans on mobile networks such as EDGE, 3G for mobiles or even on data cards. Usually, mobile service providers charge around 10p/10KB. Keep a check on the amount of data you may be using. ■

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